RING-TAILED LEMUR

Lemur catta

Think About This

If you lived in a big group, how would you know your

What can it see, hear, or feel?

It reads scents on branches, hears group alarms, and greets friends by sniffing noses.

Where does it live — and why?

It lives in Madagascar's dry forests, spending more time on the ground than most lemurs.

How does it send messages?

Males rub scent on their striped tails and wave them, and the group calls out to warn of danger.

What does it do when something changes?

It sunbathes to warm up, and the whole group moves together when a leader spots a threat.

How does it learn?

Babies ride on their mother, then copy adults to learn which plants are safe to eat.

How does it have babies?

A mother has one baby after about 135 days, and the whole group helps protect it.

What are its limits?

It needs tall trees for sleeping safely and a healthy dry forest that is quickly disappearing.

What does this teach us?

Using scent as a message shows that animals can trade information without teeth or claws.